APPENDIX 2

Using RSpec with Rails

Throughout this book, we've barely mentioned Rails, even though it's the most popular Ruby framework. This lack of emphasis is intentional. We find that if your testing fundamentals are solid and if you know how to use RSpec in a non-Rails context, it's easy to apply that knowledge to a Rails app—but not the inverse. In short, everything we've covered in this book applies to Rails apps.

With that said, we'd like to show you a few conveniences RSpec offers for testing Rails applications. In this appendix, we're going to show you how to configure a Rails app for testing with RSpec. We've also prepared some cheat sheets cataloging the features provided for working with Rails apps.

For more detailed Rails-specific testing advice, we recommend Noel Rappin's book *Rails 4 Test Prescriptions: Build a Healthy Codebase [Rap14]*. Even though the title refers to Rails 4, the advice is timeless and still applies to Rails 5. As we write this appendix, Noel is working on an updated edition for Rails 5.[1]

Installation

Rails provides infrastructure for directly testing specific pieces of your application: models, views, controllers, and so on. It also supports tests that integrate multiple layers and acceptance tests that integrate all layers.

The rspec-rails gem adapts the Rails testing infrastructure for use from RSpec. To use it, add an entry like the following one to the :development and :test groups in your Gemfile:

A2-using-rspec-with-rails/01/rails_app/Gemfile

```
group :development, :test do
  gem 'rspec-rails', '~> 3.6'
end
```

1. https://pragprog.com/book/nrtest3/rails-5-test-prescriptions